

MODRIC'S INCREDIBLE STRIKE FROM OUTSIDE THE BOX PROMPTED COACH CARLO ANCELOTTI TO CALL THE 39-YEAR-OLD A 'GIFT TO FOOTBALL' DURING HIS POST-MATCH PRESS CONFERENCE

joint record he now shares with Cesc Fabregas, who achieved that total in the 2014-15 season with Chelsea.

Meanwhile, his 16 overall assists this season are more than that of any Liverpool player in Premier League history, overtaking Steve McManaman's tally of 15 in 1995-96.

Salah has scored and assisted in 11 Premier League matches in 2024/25, the most by a player in a single season in one of Europe's big five leagues since Lionel Messi did so with 11 for Barcelona in 2014/15.

Liverpool's primary challenger, Arsenal, suffered a major setback in the title race after a 1-0 home loss against West Ham. While coach Mikel Arteta urged his players to fuel their anger positively after the loss, it would take a major collapse from Liverpool for the Gunners to come back into contention.

Another London heavyweight, Chelsea, suffered a disappointing result after losing 1-2 against Aston Villa, in a match where Marcus Rashford announced himself to Villa fans by assisting both goals for his team.

It would have been another disastrous week for Ruben Amorim after his Manchester United side trailed 0-2 against Everton at Goodison Park but a second-half charge saw the Red Devils come back and take a precious point courtesy of strikes from Bruno Fernandes and Manuel Ugarte.

Tottenham Hotspur looks like a rejuvenated side, and Ange Postecoglou's men showed that with a dominant 4-1 win against Ipswich

Town, which saw Brennan Johnson grab a brace along with strikes from Djed Spence and Dejan Kulusevski.

Newcastle United and Nottingham Forest played a seven-goal thriller, with the former bagging a 4-3 win at home.

After gameweek 26, Liverpool leads the standings with 64 points. Arsenal is second with 53, having played a game less.

Nottingham and Man City are third and fourth with 47 and 44 points, respectively. Chelsea lies seventh with 43 points, while Man United languishes in 15th with 30 points. Tottenham is 12th with 33 points.

La Liga

Barcelona needed a win to maintain momentum and stay at the top of the table, and it did so with a 2-0 away victory against Las Palmas. However, Hansi Flick's men were made to work hard.

Despite enjoying the lion's share of possession, Barca struggled to create chances in the first half, but Flick's team-talk at the break seemed to have worked as it came out all guns blazing in the second. Dani Olmo opened the scoring in the 62nd minute, and Ferran Torres added the second late in stoppage time.



Real Madrid also needed a win to keep the pressure on arch-rival Barcelona, and the defending champion did that with a 2-0 home win against Girona. The highlight of the match was Madrid's opening goal, where 39-year-old Luka Modric rolled back the years with an incredible strike from outside the box. The Croatia international was called a 'gift to football' by Ancelotti during his post-match press conference. Vinicius added Madrid's second in the 83rd minute to seal all three points for Los Blancos.

Real's city rival Atletico Madrid had a simple outing against Valencia, clinching a 3-0 away win, as Julian Alvarez bagged a brace for Diego Simeone's men.

Athletic Bilbao, which is vying for